

SURREY SCOUT

APRIL, 1977

No. 361

St. George's Day Awards 1977

SILVER WOLF

PERCY O. MORTIMER-SMITH

G.S.L. 30th REIGATE

"In recognition of services of the most exceptional character"

BAR TO THE SILVER ACORN

STANLEY L. SMART, D.S.O., D.F.C.

A.C.C. (AIR ACTIVITIES)

"In recognition of further specially distinguished service"

SILVER ACORN

BOB ALDRIDGE

J. GORDON BATES, M.A., F.C.I.S.

DAVID G. CLARK

FRANK A. FENTIMAN

MRS. JOYCE R. FENTIMAN

MRS. WINIFRED M.H. VINER

CHARLES J. WARREN

DISTRICT VICE-CHAIRMAN, ESHER.

C.C. SURREY.

G.S.L. 1st HERSHAM,

A.D.C. WALTON & WEYBRIDGE

LEADER TRAINER, SURREY and G.L.S.W.

DEPUTY C.C. SURREY

LEADER TRAINER, SURREY and G.L.S.W.

LEADER TRAINER, SURREY and G.L.S.W.

C.S.L. 5th REIGATE

"In recognition of specially distinguished services"

It is one of the pleasant traditions of St. George's Day that all of us in the Scout Association are reminded of our dependence for success in our objectives upon the devotion of both active leaders and lay helpers. Many give generously of their time and energy over a great number of years and I would like to take this opportunity of personally thanking all readers of "Surrey Scout" for all that you are doing for Scouting in the County.

At the same time, I offer our congratulations to all those who, in the past year, have been singled out for awards for their work in Scouting and in particular, the recipients of the St. George's Day Awards for 1977. The citations speak for themselves and I am sure that everyone in the County will share my particular pleasure that both our County Commissioner and Deputy County Commissioner are included.

W. GEOFFREY WRIGHT
County Chairman

County Commissioner

March 31st marks the end of one financial year in Scouting and the start of another. Traditionally it is also a time for spring cleaning.

Just as the housewife (possibly with a trailing retinue of willing and unwilling labour!) cleans through the house after the short dark days of the long winter months in preparation for summer, so we need to tidy up our affairs in Scouting and prepare for the year ahead.

First the annual accounts. At all levels, Group, District and County, the sooner these are completed and approved the better. Good book-keeping is the hall-mark of good housekeeping and there is no excuse for not getting the accounts finalised and audited by the end of April. Following Doug Bennett's articles in "Surrey Scout" we should all be able to look forward to a high standard in the presentation of accounts for 1976/77.

Then to round off the past year, there are the Annual General Meetings to be held at all levels. Regularly over past years, "Surrey Scout" has contained exhortations to make A.G.M.s both business-like and cheerful social occasions. From my visits around the County I believe this is happening. A well conducted A.G.M. is a pleasure for all concerned - as much for those organising it as for the members and invited audience! It reflects the efficiency - or otherwise - of the Group, or District, or, yes County too! It gives those present an opportunity to hear and see what is going on in Scouting these days, what it costs

and what the plans are for the future. It is an opportunity for parents and friends to identify themselves with the Movement and it is an unrivalled opportunity for good public relations.

In particular it gives us a chance to thank all those whose efforts over the past year have made it possible to provide Scouting throughout the County.

In addition, A.G.M.s give us the opportunity to springclean our own organisation structure. This year there is a particular inducement to do so for we all need to get to grips with the new organisation structure for Adult Support in Scouting. At A.G.M.s throughout Surrey as well as throughout the rest of the country, appointments will have to be made putting the new structure into effect. Guidelines on how to do this are available in Districts while the official pamphlets "The Group Council" and "The District Scout Council" together with articles which have appeared over the past year in "Scouting" are compulsory reading for all concerned. Implementation has got to be completed by the end of 1977 and the sooner we can all familiarise ourselves with the new structure in practice rather than just theory, the better.

Finally, A.G.M.s give us the opportunity to tell the world at large how, in its 70th year, Scouting really is a progressive and expanding movement with plenty of opportunities for Scoutreach in the years ahead.

GORDON BATES

Leader Training

From: David Barrell

I should like again to draw attention to the one day seminar in Dorking on 14th May 1977 entitled "The Promise & Law - What's it All About". This is an opportunity for leaders of all sections to discuss their responsibilities in relation to the aim of the Movement, that each invested member shall be encouraged to make every effort to progress in his understanding and observance of his promise "To do my best to do my duty to God".

Time will be allocated for leaders in the same sections to talk and plan together as well as mixed group discussions. The topics will include any which

participants put forward. We shall start at 11 a.m., provide a buffet lunch, and finish by 5 p.m., which leaves some shopping time in the morning and the evening free. If you are interested, let Mrs. Winnie Viner know and tell her of any subject you would like included.

The next meeting of A.D.C.s (L.T.) will take place at Bentley Copse at 3 p.m. on 7th May, when they will be looking at the support which Districts can give to leaders in this most important aspect of the Scout Training Programme.

Do remember to tell your A.D.C. of your training requirements and availabilities for courses, as the meeting will be used to lay plans for future County and other courses.

Leader Training Courses

SEMINAR

The Promise and Law
What's it All About 14th May

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

PACK HOLIDAY

Bentley Copse 16/17th April

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 20th/22nd &
(residential) 27th/29th May
Worcester Park 18th/19th/22nd/29th
(residential) June & 2nd/3rd July
4 days & 2 evenings

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

E. Daniel, Flat 7, Barfield Court, Ladbroke Road, Redhill.

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 18th/19th June &
(residential) 1st/3rd, 15/17th July

R. Wood, 2 Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley.

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 30th April/1st May
9th May evening
14th/15th May

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse & 1/2 October &
elsewhere 2 separate days in
November/December

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Air Activities

Sam Smart

You will have received your copy of the Programme of Air Experience flying for 1977, together with an explanatory letter. If you want to book a date, complete the slip as soon as possible to avoid disappointment. Remember you must pay for your flying from an "Expedition Fund" and not by direct contribution from the Scout or Scouter, so start your "Expedition Fund" now in readiness.

Scouters are you interested in introducing Air Activities into your Troop or Unit Programme? If so, why not join the Leader Course at the National Scout Air Activities Centre, Lasham, Nr. Alton, Hants, over the weekend 19th/20th November, 1977. Applications and enquiries to the Warden at Lasham. Lasham 1977. Programme includes Air Activities Weekends, Air Adventure Weekends, Parascending, Hovercrafting and Gliding. If you want regular Parascending and Gliding, you can join one of the National Clubs. Full particulars from the Warden or from me.

Directory

Staines

A.D.C. (VS). Delete D.A. Chester

Insert - B.C. Lake, The Cottage, 151a Ashford Road, Laleham, Staines, Middx. Tel. Ashford 52832

D.C.S.L. Additional - Mrs. M.M. Fletcher, 45 Gordon Close, Staines, Middx. Tel. 58907

D.S.L. Delete B.C. Lake

Insert - D.G. Wood, 63 St. Mary's Avenue, Stanwell, Staines, Middx. Tel. Ashford 51534

D.V.S.L. Insert M. Wadsworth, 82 Templedene Avenue, Staines, Middx. Tel. 56832

D.S.T.L. Amend Title to A.D.C. (Scout Fellowship)

Treasurer. Delete S.C. Duncan

Insert - A. Jones, 62 Penton Avenue, Staines, Middx. Tel. 52020

Badge Sec. Delete Mrs. V.E. Newell

Insert - Mrs. M. Jones, 62 Penton Avenue, Staines, Middx. Tel. 52020

1st Laleham Group. Delete M.L. Wadsworth

Insert - R. Budgen, 71 Pavilion Gardens, Staines, Middx. Tel. 58311

Venture Scouts

From: Bruce Wood

Windsor 1977

I feel sure that Scouters in all three sections will be glad to know that more and more members are completing their Scout training by becoming Queen's Scouts. The County will be well represented at Windsor this year by them and I know they will be inspired by the occasion. With the increased numbers of Queen's Scouts, spectator tickets are becoming hard to get but if there is any Scouter who has never been to Windsor and would like to give me a telephone call I will see what I can do, but no promises!

Sub-Committees

The attendance at the March meetings was much better although unfortunately some Districts were not represented. The Venture Scouts who came said the discussion they had with their fellows from other Districts was very useful so look in the Diary and make a note of the date of the next meetings and come along.

Scout Fellowship

From: Eric Mackie

Up to the time of writing I am only aware of the appointment of A.D.C.s (Scout Fellowship) in four Districts. I trust that this does not mean that the others do not appreciate the importance of the early creation of a District Scout Fellowship.

The Scout Fellowship scheme offers a unique opportunity to co-ordinate all existing adult help in the District, and also expand and draw in much needed new people from outside the Movement. To achieve the latter, the Scout Fellowship must be an attractive proposition for those outside the Movement, offering job satisfaction as well as an active social life.

The Scout Fellowship must not be regarded as a reserve of future uniformed section Scouters. Not everyone has the attitude, or inclination to work all the time with young people, pressure to do so and accept a regular commitment can frighten people away altogether.

Each District has varying needs of requirements, and therefore, whilst in broad outlines the local Scout Fellowship is administered in accordance with Headquarters Leaflet "Scout Fellowship", individual organisation will vary. The keyword in my mind for Scout Fellowship is Flexibility in membership, administration and work undertaken.

Here is the opportunity for each District to have at its disposal, a group of adults of both sexes, of varying ages, talents, expertise and time availability,

Executive Committees

I was looking through some back numbers of "Surrey Scout" and noticed that I wrote on this subject in April 1974. The message now seems the same as then. As I travel round the County I hear all sorts of comments about the function and working of Executive Committees. In my opinion far too many Leaders say they don't work and never will and I couldn't disagree more. We always talk of our movement providing progressive training and surely the Executive Committee is part of this training. I know, having lead a unit myself, that sometimes it is hard work to get the system going but get it going we must. It seems to me that after the Cub Scout section where the members have no executive powers and the Scout section where the Patrol Leaders Council has or should have some power the members in our section to complete their training must govern themselves through the Executive Committee. I ask all Leaders to make 1977 the year in which the system works, I know you will find it rewarding.

able to take on many varied aspects of work, from District Newsletters to Camp Site administration, from Badge Courses to Fund Raising. The range could be limitless.

Now the catch! - It is not going to be easy to set up a fellowship as I have outlined, nor will it happen overnight. There will be problems in co-ordinating the various interests and age groups. Recruiting must be carefully planned. Tasks undertaken must not overstretch or under utilise the Fellowship and its talents.

All this will take time, so the sooner we start the better chance we stand of getting something worthwhile organised. The official implementation date is December 1977, but Districts should start setting up their Scout Fellowships NOW.

I am available to help Districts in this task in any way I can, but it must be remembered that the strength of the local Scout Fellowship will be that it is geared to its own District's specific requirements. Please advise me of the details of the person appointed A.D.C. (Scout Fellowship) in your District as soon as ever possible.

With A.G.M. time approaching in Districts may I suggest a special display or feature explaining The Scout Fellowship and what it is setting out to achieve.

Finally, may I place on record my appreciation of the ready help and assistance given to me by 'Hutch' Hutchinson, The County B.P. Guild Organiser.

Congratulations

Chief Scouts Award

Timothy Hubbard
Jeffery Hunt
Gary Mills
Richard Mold
Peter Morton
John Myall
Charles Sheppard

8th Woking
4th Weybridge
1st Ashted
2nd Guildford
1st Cuddington
1st Ewell Court
1st Ewell Court

Water Activities

From: John Forbat

Training Courses

Now that spring is approaching, I hope to see the revival of canoe sessions which started last October. Please send names of Scouters, Scouts and Venture Scouts requiring B.C.U. Elementary and Proficiency training assessments to Dick Holley, Chief Examiner and G.S.L. 1st Walton-on-Thames.

John Davison has started his first series in training sessions in Chartwork and Navigation as required for R.Y.A. tidal endorsements. If you can navigate your way as far as 1st Molesey H.Q. at 193 Walton Road, East Molesey - get in touch with Dick Holley to obtain a place on this course.

County Regattas

Remember that these are open to ALL Groups and are not intended just for Sea Scouts. Some of our best canoeists have never worn blue, so note the dates in the County Diary. The Sailing Regatta would benefit from more competitors this year so please plan ahead and train in time to give the present trophy holders a surprise.

Aquameet

The application forms have been sent to all Districts and I must remind everybody that the places are limited to 125 Venture Scouts. Each year, these places are snapped up early so make sure your District has passed the forms on. If in doubt, contact Janet Jones at 34 The Poplars, Surbiton. Remember this year we shall have Longridge all to ourselves and we shall have the privilege of Lord Baden-Powell, Chief Scout Commissioner, spending the weekend with us.

County Chaplain

From: Peter Fisher

"Shop at the duty-free store!" We seem to see more of that slogan these days. Can it be that the advertisers want us to book an air fare to Rio just to halve the price of our whisky? Come to think of it, it wouldn't be such a bad idea! But, seriously, the idea of getting things 'duty free' has a natural appeal in this age of high taxation. And so does the idea of living 'duty free'. The very word 'duty' has a heavy sound to it, it smacks of obligations the world imposes on us, or some archaic code requires of us, against our own free will. No wonder many Leaders find it difficult to communicate that part of Scouting which relates to 'duties'.

In some ways we have to admit that the present-day reaction against 'dutiful' behaviour is a good reaction. Nowadays there is a real recognition that the best words and actions have something spontaneous about them, and that the person who 'does good' for the sake of a moral principle rather than a person can be a pain in the neck. - C.S. Lewis wrote that you could tell the recipients of such people's kindness by their hunted look!

So we want to avoid leading others, by word or example, to be dutiful in a stiff, rule-book sort of way; like saying prayers by the stop-watch, or doing precisely one good deed per day. But that doesn't mean that we chuck the concept of duty out of the window, either with respect to God (and neighbour) or Queen (and country). In fact, in an era of all-out spontaneity we may need to give it a little more attention.

We may need to point out that praying, being kind, taking responsibility just when we 'feel like it' may be as bad for us and for others as not doing any of these things at all. To do the shopping for an old person *once* can be a tiny bit cruel, however kindly meant. To do justice to our (spontaneous) sense of gratitude to God for life and to others for all they give us we have to make some (dutiful) personal undertakings which we will stick to through thick and thin. A jelly-fish may be overflowing with charity, but it can't do much to help its neighbour. We may need a little stiffening ourselves - not stiff upper lips, or starchy exteriors, but the inner strength of a consistent resolve and a regular habit of taking responsibility, being kind, yes, and praying, too.

Here and There

Census

District Secretaries have a great deal to do at this time of the year. Their time is valuable and it is unfair, unthinking and unkind to expect them to chase YOU for your Census Return. If you are in charge of a Section, or a Group, please be sure to complete your part in the Census as quickly and as accurately as you can. Last year, some 20 people held up the County return by holding up the District returns. This year, please, PLEASE, don't be the one to hold things up.

And District Secretaries, please note that District Returns should be sent to D.W. Bennett, 'Pheasantwood', Sheephouse Lane, Wotton, Abinger Hammer, Dorking, Surrey, who is dealing with the Census on behalf of the County.

HQ and County Subscriptions

Groups are reminded that HQ and County Subscriptions are due to be paid to the District Treasurer on 1st April, so that he can pass the money on to the County Treasurer as soon as possible after that date, who in turn passes it on to Headquarters. If the money is not paid on time, Headquarters chases the County Treasurer, who chases the District Treasurer, who chases the G.S.L. who chases . . . so please - let's make it easier for everyone this year.

The Reigate District Annual Buffet Dance

The Dance will be held at the Royal Alexandra and Albert School, Gatton Park, Reigate, on Saturday, 2nd April, 1977. Dancing 8 p.m. to Mtd. A licenced bar will be provided. Dancing to Johnny Douglas Band. Admission, including Buffet and Wine, £2.50. Tickets are available from E.T. Bashford, 42 Park Lane, Reigate.

Walton Firs Cub Scout Day

On Saturday, 10th September, 1977, Walton Firs will be open to Cub Scouts and their Leaders. Various demonstrations will take place and there will be a number of events and competitions in which the Cub Scouts may take part. Cost will be 30p per head and there will be no other charges for events or activities other than rides on the traction engine and on the monkee-bikes (4p a time). Numbers are restricted to 1,500 so it is worth booking NOW. Details from The Warden, Walton Firs National Scout Camp, Burwood Park, Cobham, Surrey KT11 1HB (and don't forget the stamped addressed envelope).

Scout Air Rifle Competition

Also at Walton Firs, 30th September/2nd October, this meeting will be presented and supervised by the National Air Rifle and Pistol Association. Stay for the weekend or visit on the Saturday or Sunday. Full information from the Warden (address above), enclose a large stamped addressed envelope.

County Diary

April

6	County Executive Committee	B.-P. House
11-16	Scout Job Week	
18	Combined Cub Scout & Scout Sub-Committee Meeting	Leatherhead
24	National Scout Service	Windsor

May

27	County A.G.M.	Woking
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June

2	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
11	Chief Scout's Award Certificate Presentation	Epsom
13	Finance Committee	Leatherhead
16	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Walton-on-T
24/26	Aquameet	Longridge

July

4	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
10	County Regatta	Walton-on-T
14	P. & T. Meeting	N. Holmwood
20	County Executive Committee	B.-P. House

September

11	Sailing Regatta	'Ajax' HQ
12	Finance Committee	Leatherhead
15	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
15	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Dorking
24/25	Scout Camping Competition	Bentley Copse

October

3	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
4	Cub Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
10	P. & T. Meeting	Gt. Bookham
19	County Executive Committee	B.-P. House
	Chief Scout's Award Certificate Presentation	Guildford

December

1	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
12	Finance Committee	Leatherhead
13	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Cuddington

May "Surrey Scout"

Copy Date	9th April
Distribution	24th April